Kiran was extremely uneasy in the position she then occupied. Her boss was breathing down her neck more and more. It was gradually becoming suffocating for her. She wished she could move away to avoid a brewing confrontation, which would have been detrimental if she had to reach the top position. There were just a few days left before the 'editing' boss would have got the right to write her performance report. She knew what he would do. She fervently wished for a way out before he could get going. And Providence fulfilled her wish; in fact, it was a dream come true for her. But this new posting was one that would take her away from home for a long period.

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Kiran received a proposal to take up a senior position in the United Nations at New York. This assignment meant working from outside the country and her first reaction was a categorical 'never'. But then came the sudden realization of the prospect of moving away from the current negativity and gaining international experience on a larger and wider scale at the same time. She earnestly prepared for, and went through, the interview and then waited for the result. What if she did not make it, she thought, for she was competing with many experienced internationally renowned candidates! The media headline would be: 'KIRAN BEDI FAILS US.'

But God had definite plans for her. She was selected to be the 'cop of the world'!

The secretary-general of the United Nations, Kofi Annan, appointed her as the civilian police adviser in January 2003. Kiran was chosen from a panel of distinguished candidates. This posting was yet another 'first' – this time not within India but across the world – and Kiran became the first woman police adviser in the United Nations.

The Civilian Police Division, to which she was assigned, comprises senior civilian police officers from different parts of the world. They all work together in close coordination with other concerned departments and agencies of the United Nations in war-torn areas affected by interstate and intrastate conflicts, whenever and wherever the Security Council mandates them to do so. The CPD and its officers report, at regular intervals, to the member-states through various committees and organs of the United Nations.

Kiran and her colleagues worked under the able guidance of her senior, Jean Marie Guéhenno, the under secretary-general, who hailed from France. To understand her work better and to get a wider perspective, Kiran visited the field missions where the United Nations Civilian Police (UNCIVPOL) was deployed. She travelled to Timor Leste (formerly East Timor, in South-east Asia), Sierra Leone (in southwestern Africa) and Kosova (in southern Europe). Other areas that came under the umbrella of responsibility of her CPD included the Democratic Republic of Congo, Georgia, Cyprus and Liberia.

When asked how she found the new assignment with the United Nations, she replied diplomatically: 'Peace watching and peace reading to peace keeping.' When asked to clarify, she said: 'So far, I used to watch all these developments on the television or read about the matters in the papers. Now I am a slice of the scenario.' She was asked how she 'felt' in the assignment. Pat came the reply: 'A global citizen indeed!' She added that she was being guided by a 'brilliant internationalist'. When asked about her reactions as an Indian in the United Nations, she responded:

> I am indebted to my parents and my family for the unstinted support; my superiors for the valuable guidance; my colleagues for their energy and willing cooperation; and my countrymen and women for the abundant love and trust, but most of all for the bountiful grace of the Almighty.